

COMPLETE ENGLISH GRAMMAR

THE FULL STRUCTURED NOTES SERIES

PART	SERIES	COVERAGE
A	The Word Series	WH-words · ANY · NO · EVERY · SOME
B	The Pronoun & Determiner Series	All Types
C	The Sentence Structure Series	50+ I-Patterns
D	Complete Grammar Reference	Tenses · Modals · Conditionals

Beginner to Upper-Intermediate · Full Explanations · Comprehensive Tables · Examples Throughout

TABLE OF CONTENTS

PART A — THE WORD SERIES

- Ch 1** Question Words — What, Where, When, Why, Who, Whom, Which, Whose, How
- Ch 2** How + Adjective Series — How much, How many, How long, How far, How old...
- Ch 3** The SOME- Series — Someone, Somebody, Something, Somewhere
- Ch 4** The ANY- Series — Anyone, Anybody, Anything, Anywhere
- Ch 5** The NO- Series — No one, Nobody, Nothing, Nowhere
- Ch 6** The EVERY- Series — Everyone, Everybody, Everything, Everywhere
- Ch 7** The EITHER / NEITHER / BOTH Series
- Ch 8** Quantifiers — Some, Any, Much, Many, A lot, A few, A little, Enough, Too

PART B — THE PRONOUN & DETERMINER SERIES

- Ch 9** Subject Pronouns — I, You, He, She, It, We, They
- Ch 10** Object Pronouns — Me, You, Him, Her, It, Us, Them
- Ch 11** Possessive Adjectives & Pronouns — My/Mine, Your/Yours, etc.
- Ch 12** Reflexive Pronouns — Myself, Yourself, Himself...
- Ch 13** Demonstrative Pronouns/Determiners — This, That, These, Those
- Ch 14** Relative Pronouns — Who, Whom, Whose, Which, That

PART C — THE SENTENCE STRUCTURE SERIES (50+ PATTERNS)

- Ch 15** The I AM / I WAS Series — States, Descriptions, Conditions
- Ch 16** The I LIKE / I LOVE / I HATE Series — Expressing Preferences
- Ch 17** The I WANT TO / I NEED TO / I HAVE TO Series
- Ch 18** The I WOULD LIKE TO / I'D PREFER TO Series — Polite Desire
- Ch 19** The I USED TO / I WOULD Series — Past Habits
- Ch 20** The I AM GOING TO / I WILL Series — Future Intentions
- Ch 21** The I HAVE BEEN / I HAD BEEN Series — Perfect Tenses
- Ch 22** The I SHOULD / I MUST / I CAN Series — Modals Complete
- Ch 23** The I SHOULD HAVE / I COULD HAVE / I WOULD HAVE Series
- Ch 24** The I WAS GOING TO / I WAS ABOUT TO Series
- Ch 25** The I KEEP / I TEND TO / I HAPPEN TO Series

PART D — COMPLETE GRAMMAR REFERENCE

- Ch 26** All Tenses — Complete Reference Table
- Ch 27** Question Tags — Full Reference

Ch 28 Conditionals — Zero, First, Second, Third, Mixed

Ch 29 Articles, Prepositions, and Conjunctions

Ch 30 Practice Exercises — All Parts

PART A

THE WORD SERIES

WH-words · SOME · ANY · NO · EVERY · Quantifiers

CHAPTER 1

Question Words — WH-Words

Question words (also called **WH-words** or interrogatives) are placed at the start of a question to ask for specific information. Each word targets a different type of information.

Word	Asks About	Example Question	Example Answer
What	Things, actions, ideas	What is your job?	I am a teacher.
Where	Place / location	Where do you live?	I live in Sharjah.
When	Time / moment	When is your birthday?	It is on 14 March.
Who	Person — subject of sentence	Who called you last night?	My brother.
Whom	Person — object (formal)	Whom did you call?	I called the manager.
Whose	Ownership / possession	Whose keys are these?	They are mine.
Which	Choice between options	Which bag do you prefer?	The red one.
Why	Reason / cause	Why were you late?	Traffic was terrible.
How	Manner / method / condition	How do you go to work?	I take the metro.

Structure of WH-Questions

■ Question Word + Auxiliary (do/does/did/is/are/was/were/will/have) + Subject + Main Verb + ?

- *What do you do at weekends?*
- *Where does she work?*
- *Why did they leave early?*
- *When will the meeting start?*
- *How has he been feeling lately?*

■ When WHO or WHAT is itself the subject, do NOT add do/does/did. Example: 'Who called you?' NOT 'Who did call you?' | But: 'Who did you call?' (YOU is the subject, WHO is the object).

CHAPTER 2

The HOW + Adjective / Adverb Series

'How' combines with adjectives and adverbs to form a very important series of question types.

Expression	Asks About	Example Question	Example Answer
How old	Age	How old are you?	I am 29 years old.
How much	Price / uncountable	How much does it cost?	50 dirhams.
How many	Countable quantity	How many children do you have?	I have two.
How long	Duration / length	How long does it take?	About 40 minutes.

Expression	Asks About	Example Question	Example Answer
How often	Frequency	How often do you exercise?	Three times a week.
How far	Distance	How far is the airport?	About 15 km.
How tall	Height (person)	How tall is he?	1 metre 80.
How high	Height (object)	How high is that building?	Over 400 metres.
How wide	Width	How wide is the road?	About 6 metres.
How deep	Depth	How deep is the pool?	2 metres.
How heavy	Weight	How heavy is the package?	About 3 kg.
How fast	Speed	How fast can this car go?	Up to 220 km/h.
How soon	Imminence	How soon can you be ready?	In 10 minutes.
How well	Ability / quality	How well do you speak French?	Fairly well.
How come	Reason (informal)	How come you were late?	Alarm didn't go off.

CHAPTER 3

The SOME- Series

Words formed with **SOME-** refer to unspecified or unknown people, things, and places, mainly used in positive (affirmative) sentences, offers, and requests.

Word	Refers To	Used In	Example
Someone / Somebody	An unspecified person	Positive, offers, requests	Someone left a message for you.
Something	An unspecified thing	Positive, offers, requests	There is something in the bag.
Somewhere	An unspecified place	Positive sentences	Let's go somewhere nice.

Using SOME- in offers and requests

- *Would you like something to eat? (offer — we expect YES)*
- *Can I get you something to drink? (offer)*
- *Could someone help me with this, please? (polite request)*

CHAPTER 4

The ANY- Series

Words formed with **ANY-** are used in questions, negative sentences, and also in positive sentences meaning 'it does not matter which'.

Word	Refers To	Used In	Example
Anyone / Anybody	An unspecified person	Questions, negatives, 'no matter who'	Is there anybody here? / I didn't see anyone.
Anything	An unspecified thing	Questions, negatives, 'no matter what'	Did you eat anything? / I'll eat anything.
Anywhere	An unspecified place	Questions, negatives, 'no matter where'	Can we go anywhere you like.

ANY- in the special meaning 'no matter which/who/where'

- *You can choose anything from the menu. (= no matter what)*
- *Anybody can learn English with practice. (= no matter who)*
- *We can meet anywhere that suits you. (= no matter where)*

CHAPTER 5

The NO- Series

Words formed with **NO-** indicate a complete absence or zero quantity. They are used with **affirmative** verbs — NEVER with negative verbs.

Word	Example (CORRECT)	Wrong — Double Negative ✗
No one / Nobody	No one came to the meeting.	There wasn't nobody there. ✗

Word	Example (CORRECT)	Wrong — Double Negative ✗
Nothing	Nothing happened.	I didn't do nothing . ✗
Nowhere	There is nowhere to park.	I didn't go nowhere . ✗

■ 'No one' and 'nobody' mean the same thing. Write 'no one' as two words — NOT 'noone'.

CHAPTER 6

The EVERY- Series

Words formed with **EVERY-** refer to all people, all things, or all places without exception. They always take a **singular** verb.

Word	Means	Example
Everyone / Everybody	All people	Everyone enjoyed the presentation.
Everything	All things	Everything was perfect at the event.
Everywhere	All places	She has travelled everywhere in Europe.

■ These words are grammatically singular even though they refer to 'all'. Use singular verbs: 'Everyone **IS** here' (not 'are'). However, use 'they/their' as a gender-neutral pronoun: 'Everybody should bring their own lunch.'

The Complete Four-Way Table — All Four Families

	Person	Thing	Place
SOME-	Someone / Somebody	Something	Somewhere
ANY-	Anyone / Anybody	Anything	Anywhere
NO-	No one / Nobody	Nothing	Nowhere
EVERY-	Everyone / Everybody	Everything	Everywhere

CHAPTER 7

The EITHER / NEITHER / BOTH Series

Word	Meaning	Used With	Example
Both	The two — together	Plural verb	Both brothers are doctors.
Either	One or the other (not both)	Singular verb	Either day is fine for me.
Neither	Not one and not the other	Singular verb	Neither answer is correct.
Both...and	The first AND the second	Plural	Both Ali and Sara passed.
Either...or	The first OR the second	Singular	Either Tom or Maria will present.
Neither...nor	Not the first AND not the second	Singular	Neither Tom nor Maria is ready.

- *I like both options. / Both of them agreed.*
- *Either option works for me. / You can take either road.*
- *Neither film was worth watching. / Neither of us knew the answer.*

CHAPTER 8

Quantifiers — Some, Any, Much, Many, A lot, A few...

Quantifier	Used With	Sentence Type	Example
some	Count./Uncountable	Positive (+)	I have some money. / Can I have some water?
any	Count./Uncountable	Negative / ?	I don't have any time. / Do you have any ideas?
much	Uncountable only	Neg. / Question	I don't have much time. / How much water?
many	Countable only	Neg. / Question	There aren't many students here.
a lot of	Both	Mainly positive	She has a lot of experience.
a few	Countable only	Positive	I have a few questions for you.
few	Countable only	Negative idea	Few people know the answer. (almost none)
a little	Uncountable only	Positive	Can I have a little more time?
little	Uncountable only	Negative idea	There is little hope of success.
enough	Both	All types	Do we have enough chairs for everyone?
too much	Uncountable	Negative excess	He drinks too much coffee.
too many	Countable	Negative excess	There are too many cars on the road.
no	Both	Positive verb	There is no time left. / I have no idea.

PART B

THE PRONOUN & DETERMINER SERIES

Subject · Object · Possessive · Reflexive · Demonstrative · Relative

CHAPTER 9

Subject Pronouns

Subject pronouns replace the noun that performs the action. They always come **BEFORE** the verb.

Pronoun	Person / Number	Replaces	Example
I	1st singular	The speaker	I am a nurse. / I live in Abu Dhabi.
You	2nd sing./plural	The listener(s)	You are very talented.
He	3rd singular (male)	A male person/name	David works here. He is efficient.
She	3rd singular (female)	A female person/name	Maria is a lawyer. She works long hours.
It	3rd singular (thing)	A thing, animal, situation	It is raining. / The cat wants food.
We	1st plural	Speaker + others	My colleague and I — we travelled to London.
They	3rd plural	Other people / things	The students finished early. They were well-prepared.

CHAPTER 10

Object Pronouns

Object pronouns replace a noun that receives the action, or that follows a preposition. They always come **AFTER** the verb or preposition.

Subject	Object	After a Verb	After a Preposition
I	me	She called me.	Between you and me.
You	you	I saw you yesterday.	This is for you.
He	him	We invited him.	She is talking about him.
She	her	I called her twice.	I bought it for her.
It	it	Put it on the table.	He is looking at it.
We	us	The teacher praised us.	They are waiting for us.
They	them	I told them the news.	This belongs to them.

CHAPTER 11

Possessive Adjectives & Possessive Pronouns

Possessive adjectives come **BEFORE** a noun (my car). **Possessive pronouns** stand **ALONE** — no noun follows them (the car is mine).

Subject	Poss. Adjective	Example (+noun)	Poss. Pronoun	Example (alone)
I	my	my passport	mine	This passport is mine.
You	your	your opinion	yours	That seat is yours.

Subject	Poss. Adjective	Example (+noun)	Poss. Pronoun	Example (alone)
He	his	his office	his	The car is his.
She	her	her briefcase	hers	That briefcase is hers.
It	its	its colour	—	(no standalone pronoun for 'it')
We	our	our company	ours	This project is ours.
They	their	their dept.	theirs	The decision is theirs.

Possessive 's and s' — Showing Ownership

Rule	Example
Singular noun: add 's	Ahmed's car / the manager's office / today's meeting
Plural noun ending in -s: add '	the students' books / the managers' offices
Irregular plural (not -s): add 's	the children's classroom / the men's team
Question form: Whose + noun?	Whose phone is this? — It is Sara's.

CHAPTER 12

Reflexive Pronouns — Myself, Yourself, Himself...

Reflexive pronouns are used when the subject and object refer to the same person, and also for **emphasis**.

Subject	Reflexive	Use (same person)	Use (emphasis)
I	myself	I hurt myself.	I did it myself.
You	yourself	Did you enjoy yourself?	You must decide for yourself.
He	himself	He taught himself English.	The director himself attended.
She	herself	She introduced herself.	She cooked everything herself.
It	itself	The machine turns itself off.	The problem resolved itself.
We	ourselves	We prepared ourselves.	We built this company ourselves.
You(pl)	yourselves	Please help yourselves.	Be proud of yourselves.
They	themselves	They blamed themselves.	They painted the house themselves.

CHAPTER 13

Demonstrative Pronouns & Determiners

Word	Number	Distance	As Determiner (+noun)	As Pronoun (stands alone)
This	Singular	Near	This report is excellent.	This is my colleague, Sara.
That	Singular	Far	That building is the HQ.	That was a great idea.

Word	Number	Distance	As Determiner (+noun)	As Pronoun (stands alone)
These	Plural	Near	These documents need signing.	These are the latest figures.
Those	Plural	Far	Those files are confidential.	Those were different times.

■ On the phone, say 'This is Ahmed speaking' — never 'That is'.

CHAPTER 14

Relative Pronouns — Who, Whom, Whose, Which, That

Relative pronouns introduce **relative clauses** — clauses that give extra information about a noun.

Pronoun	Refers To	Function	Example
Who	Person	Subject of clause	The manager who called you is waiting outside.
Whom	Person	Object of clause (formal)	The person whom I called never replied.
Whose	Person / Thing	Possession	The student whose essay won first prize.
Which	Thing / Animal	Subject or object	The report which you submitted was excellent.
That	Person / Thing	Subject or object (informal)	The car that I bought last year is broken.

Defining vs. Non-Defining Relative Clauses

Type	Punctuation	Meaning	Example
Defining	No commas	Identifies which person/thing — cannot be removed	The employee that won the award is in Finance.
Non-defining	Commas used	Adds extra (optional) info — can be removed	Mr Hassan, who has been with us for 10 years, is retiring.

■ 'That' cannot be used in non-defining clauses. Use 'who' for people and 'which' for things in non-defining clauses.

PART C

THE SENTENCE STRUCTURE SERIES

50+ Essential I-Patterns · Every Key Structure You Need

CHAPTER 15

The I AM / I WAS Series — States and Descriptions

This series uses the verb **'to be'** in all its forms to describe states, identity, feelings, and conditions.

I am + adjective/noun

- *I am ready.*
- *I am a project manager.*
- *I am very grateful for your help.*

I am not + adj/noun

- *I am not sure about that.*
- *I am not available this afternoon.*

I was + adj/noun

- *I was very tired after the conference.*
- *I was a student ten years ago.*

I was not (wasn't) + ...

- *I wasn't aware of that policy.*
- *I wasn't ready for the interview.*

I have been + adj/noun

- *I have been very busy this week.*
- *I have been a member since 2018.*

I had been + adj/noun

- *I had been ill for a week before the meeting.*

I will be + adj/noun

- *I will be available from Monday.*
- *I will be in the office tomorrow.*

I would be + adj/noun

- *I would be happy to help.*
- *I would be grateful if you could confirm.*

CHAPTER 16

The I LIKE / I LOVE / I HATE Series — Preferences

Pattern	Structure	Example
I like	I like + noun / verb-ing	I like jazz music. / I like swimming.
I love	I love + noun / verb-ing	I love travelling. / I love this city.

Pattern	Structure	Example
I enjoy	I enjoy + verb-ing only	I enjoy reading in the evening.
I prefer	I prefer A to B / + verb-ing	I prefer coffee to tea.
I don't like	I don't like + noun / verb-ing	I don't like cold weather.
I dislike	I dislike + verb-ing	I dislike working under pressure.
I hate	I hate + noun / verb-ing	I hate waking up early on Mondays.
I can't stand	I can't stand + noun/verb-ing	I can't stand waiting for long.
I don't mind	I don't mind + noun/verb-ing	I don't mind working overtime.
I am keen on	I am keen on + noun/verb-ing	I am keen on learning new languages.
I am fond of	I am fond of + noun	I am fond of classical literature.
I am interested in	I am interested in + noun	I am interested in the new proposal.

CHAPTER 17

I WANT TO / I NEED TO / I HAVE TO — Desire, Need, Obligation

I want to + base verb

- *I want to speak to the manager.*
- *I want to book a flight for next Tuesday.*

I don't want to + base verb

- *I don't want to be late for the meeting.*
- *I don't want to disappoint the team.*

I need to + base verb

- *I need to finish this report by Friday.*
- *I need to call the client this afternoon.*

I don't need to + base verb

- *I don't need to attend — you can represent me.*

I have to + base verb

- *I have to travel to Riyadh on Monday.*
- *I have to meet a very strict deadline.*

I don't have to + base verb

- *I don't have to wear a uniform. It is optional.*

I had to + base verb

- *I had to cancel the meeting at short notice.*
- *I had to work through the night.*

I will have to + base verb

- *I will have to reschedule our appointment.*

I am supposed to + base verb

- *I am supposed to submit the report today.*

I ought to + base verb

- *I ought to reply to those emails today.*

CHAPTER 18

I WOULD LIKE TO / I'D PREFER — Polite Desire**I would like to + base verb (I'd like to...)**

- *I would like to make a reservation for two.*
- *I'd like to discuss the budget with you.*

I would like + noun

- *I would like a window seat, please.*
- *I'd like the grilled fish, thank you.*

Would you like to + base verb?

- *Would you like to join us for lunch?*
- *Would you like me to explain the process again?*

I would prefer to + base verb

- *I would prefer to travel by train.*
- *I'd prefer to receive the report by email.*

I would rather + base verb (no 'to')

- *I would rather wait here.*
- *I'd rather not discuss this now.*
- *I'd rather you told me directly.*

I would love to + base verb

- *I would love to attend the conference.*
- *I'd love to work with your team on this.*

I would hate to + base verb

- *I would hate to miss this opportunity.*
- *I'd hate to cause any inconvenience.*

CHAPTER 19

I USED TO / I WOULD — Past Habits

Both 'used to' and 'would' describe past habits or repeated actions that no longer happen. However, only 'used to' can describe past **states**. 'Would' cannot be used for states.

I used to + base verb (past habit or state that no longer exists)

- *I used to live in Cairo before moving here.*
- *I used to work much longer hours when I was younger.*
- *She used to be very shy — you wouldn't recognise her now.*

I didn't use to + base verb

- *I didn't use to drink coffee, but now I can't start the day without it.*

Did you use to + base verb?

- *Did you use to play football when you were at school?*

I would + base verb (repeated past action only — NOT states)

- *Every summer, we would travel to the mountains.*
- *She would always bring homemade food to the office.*

I am used to + noun/verb-ing (= accustomed to — present)

- *I am used to working under pressure.*
- *I am used to the heat — I have lived here for years.*

I got used to + verb-ing (= became accustomed to — process)

- *I got used to the new system after a few weeks.*

CHAPTER 20

I AM GOING TO / I WILL — Future Intentions**I am going to + base verb (planned intention or evidence-based prediction)**

- *I am going to apply for the position.*
- *We are going to launch the new product next quarter.*
- *Look at those clouds — it is going to rain.*

I will + base verb (spontaneous decision, promise, offer, prediction)

- *I will call you when I arrive.*
- *Don't worry, I'll help you with that.*
- *I think this strategy will work well.*

I am planning to + base verb

- *I am planning to move to a new office next year.*

I am thinking of + verb-ing

- *I am thinking of taking an advanced management course.*

I am about to + base verb (very near future — happening now)

- *I am about to send the email.*
- *The meeting is about to begin — please take your seats.*

I am due to + base verb (scheduled)

- *I am due to present the report on Wednesday.*
- *The flight is due to land at 14:30.*

CHAPTER 21

The HAVE BEEN / HAD BEEN Series — Perfect Tenses**I have + past participle (Present Perfect — past action with present relevance)**

- *I have finished the report.*
- *I have lived here for five years.*
- *I have never been to Tokyo.*

I have been + verb-ing (Present Perfect Continuous — ongoing from past to now)

- *I have been working on this project since January.*
- *She has been waiting for over an hour.*
- *We have been trying to contact you all morning.*

I had + past participle (Past Perfect — action before another past action)

- *By the time I arrived, they had already started.*
- *She realised she had forgotten her passport.*

I had been + verb-ing (Past Perfect Continuous)

➤ *I had been working for 12 hours before I realised the time.*

I will have + past participle (Future Perfect)

➤ *By next Friday, I will have completed the entire project.*

CHAPTER 22

I SHOULD / I MUST / I CAN — The Complete Modal Series

Pattern	Meaning	Example
I can	Ability; informal permission	I can speak three languages.
I can't	Inability; prohibition	I can't attend the meeting on Monday.
I could	Past ability; polite request; possibility	I could help you with that.
I couldn't	Past inability; impossibility	I couldn't hear you — the line was bad.
I should	Advice; mild obligation	I should reply to his email.
I shouldn't	Advice against; mild prohibition	I shouldn't have agreed to that.
I must	Strong obligation; logical deduction	I must prepare better next time.
I mustn't	Prohibition — not allowed	You mustn't share this externally.
I may	Formal permission; 50% possibility	I may be late — the traffic is heavy.
I might	Weak possibility (~30–40%)	I might attend the conference.
I will	Certain future; promise; willingness	I will send you the details by end of day.
I would	Hypothetical; polite request	I would appreciate a quick response.
I need to	Necessity (less strong than must)	I need to finish this today.
I don't need to	No necessity (different from mustn't!)	I don't need to come — it's optional.

CHAPTER 23

I SHOULD HAVE / I COULD HAVE / I WOULD HAVE — Perfect Modals

Perfect modals combine a modal verb with **have + past participle**. They refer to past situations — things that did or did not happen, and our judgement about them NOW.

Pattern	Meaning	Example
I should have	Right thing to do, but I didn't.	I should have replied to that email earlier.
I shouldn't have	Wrong thing to do, and I did it.	I shouldn't have agreed to such a tight deadline.
I could have	Possible, but I chose not to / it didn't happen	I could have taken the earlier flight.
I couldn't have	Was not possible at all.	I couldn't have done it without your support.
I would have	Hypothetical past — under a different condition	I would have attended if I had known earlier.
I wouldn't have	Hypothetical — this would NOT have happened	I wouldn't have accepted had I known the truth.
I might have	Weak past possibility — maybe it happened	I might have left my phone in the conference room.
I must have	Logical deduction about the past.	I must have sent the email to the wrong address.

Pattern	Meaning	Example
I can't have	Logical deduction — something is impossible.	She can't have received my message.
I needn't have	Not necessary, but it was done.	I needn't have prepared so many slides.

CHAPTER 24

I WAS GOING TO / I WAS ABOUT TO — Unfulfilled Intentions

This series describes plans or intentions that did **NOT** happen — they were interrupted, cancelled, or changed.

I was going to + base verb (had a plan, but it did not happen)

- *I was going to call you, but something urgent came up.*
- *We were going to launch in March, but the project was delayed.*

I was about to + base verb (was on the verge of doing it, but was stopped)

- *I was about to leave the office when my phone rang.*
- *She was about to sign the contract when she noticed an error.*

I had planned to + base verb

- *I had planned to submit the report yesterday, but the data wasn't ready.*

I had intended to + base verb

- *I had intended to respond sooner — I apologise for the delay.*

I was hoping to + base verb

- *I was hoping to get your feedback before the end of the week.*

I had meant to + base verb

- *I had meant to send you that report last week.*

CHAPTER 25

I KEEP / I TEND TO / I HAPPEN TO — Habits & Tendencies**I keep + verb-ing (an annoying or repeated action — often unintentional)**

- *I keep forgetting to charge my phone.*
- *She keeps interrupting people in meetings.*

I tend to + base verb (a general tendency or habit)

- *I tend to arrive early for appointments.*
- *He tends to overthink every decision.*

I happen to + base verb (by chance; unexpectedly)

- *I happened to see your colleague at the airport.*
- *Do you happen to know his contact number?*

I end up + verb-ing (an unintended result)

- *I always end up working late when I don't plan properly.*

I find it + adjective + to + base verb

➤ *I find it difficult to concentrate in noisy environments.*

I make a point of + verb-ing (a deliberate, consistent habit)

➤ *I make a point of acknowledging every email I receive.*

I can't help + verb-ing (unable to stop the action)

➤ *I can't help laughing when he tells that story.*

I look forward to + verb-ing (anticipation — key for emails)

➤ *I look forward to hearing from you.*

➤ *We look forward to welcoming you to our team.*

PART D

COMPLETE GRAMMAR REFERENCE

Tenses · Question Tags · Conditionals · Articles · Prepositions

CHAPTER 26

All Tenses — Complete Reference Table

Tense	Structure	Main Use	Example
Present Simple	V / V+s	Habits, facts, routines	I work / She works.
Present Continuous	am/is/are + V-ing	Action happening now	I am working.
Present Perfect	have/has + p.p.	Past action relevant to now	I have finished.
Pres. Perfect Cont.	have/has been + V-ing	Ongoing action from past to now	I have been working all day.
Past Simple	V-ed / irregular	Completed past action	I worked / She worked.
Past Continuous	was/were + V-ing	Action in progress at past moment	I was working when you called.
Past Perfect	had + p.p.	Action before another past action	I had finished before she arrived.
Past Perfect Cont.	had been + V-ing	Ongoing action before past moment	I had been working for 6 hours.
Future Simple	will + base verb	Spontaneous decisions; promises	I will call you.
Going To Future	am/is/are going to + base	Planned intentions; evidence	I am going to travel.
Future Continuous	will be + V-ing	Action in progress at future time	I will be working at 8 pm.
Future Perfect	will have + p.p.	Completed before a future time	By Friday I will have finished.

CHAPTER 27

Question Tags — Full Reference

■ RULE: Positive statement + NEGATIVE tag / Negative statement + POSITIVE tag

Statement	Tag	Full Sentence
I am late	aren't I?	I am late, aren't I?
You are ready	aren't you?	You are ready, aren't you?
He is a doctor	isn't he?	He is a doctor, isn't he?
She was angry	wasn't she?	She was angry, wasn't she?
It was expensive	wasn't it?	It was expensive, wasn't it?
We are on time	aren't we?	We are on time, aren't we?
They were there	weren't they?	They were there, weren't they?
You speak English	don't you?	You speak English, don't you?
She likes coffee	doesn't she?	She likes coffee, doesn't she?
He went home	didn't he?	He went home, didn't he?
She can swim	can't she?	She can swim, can't she?
He won't come	will he?	He won't come, will he?

Statement	Tag	Full Sentence
They have finished	haven't they?	They have finished, haven't they?
You don't smoke	do you?	You don't smoke, do you?
She isn't here	is she?	She isn't here, is she?
We should leave	shouldn't we?	We should leave, shouldn't we?
Let's go	shall we?	Let's go, shall we?
Open the window	will you?	Open the window, will you?

■ 'I am' is a special case — the tag is 'aren't I?' not 'amn't I?' Example: I am your new colleague, aren't I?

CHAPTER 28

Conditionals — Zero, First, Second, Third, Mixed

Type	Structure	Use	Example
Zero Conditional	If + Present Simple, + Present Simple	General truths; scientific laws	If you heat ice, it melts.
First Conditional	If + Present Simple, + will + base verb	Real / likely future situation	If I finish early, I will call you.
Second Conditional	If + Past Simple, + would + base verb	Hypothetical / unlikely present/future	If I had more time, I would study another language.
Third Conditional	If + Past Perfect, + would have + past participle	Hypothetical / impossible past	If I had known, I would have told you.
Mixed Conditional	If + Past Perfect, + would + base verb	Past condition with present result	If I had taken that job, I would be in London now.

■ The IF-clause can come first or second. When it comes first, use a comma. When it comes second, no comma is needed. Example: 'I will call you if I finish early.' (no comma needed)

CHAPTER 29

Articles, Prepositions, and Conjunctions

Articles — A, An, The

Article	Use	Examples
a	Singular countable nouns — consonant SOUND	A book, a university (specific), a European
an	Singular countable nouns — vowel SOUND	an apple, an hour (h is silent), an MBA, an umbrella
the	Specific / already known / unique / superlatives	the river, the hills, the best, the task I mentioned
—	No article for: plural general statements; uncountable nouns	table tennis, Drugs are illegal, She is a nurse. Dubai.

Prepositions of Time

Preposition	Use	Examples
at	Specific times; festivals; meal times	at 9 o'clock, at Christmas, at lunch, at night
on	Days; dates; specific named times	on Monday, on 15 July, on my birthday
in	Months; years; seasons; parts of day	in March, in 2024, in summer, in the morning
for	Duration	for three days, for a long time, for two years
since	From a point in the past to now	since Monday, since 2018, since I arrived
by	Deadline / not later than	by Friday, by 5 pm, by the end of the month
until/till	Up to a specific time	I will wait until 6 pm. / open till 8.
during	Within a period of time	during the meeting, during summer, during the flight

Common Coordinating and Subordinating Conjunctions

Conjunction	Type	Use	Example
and	Coordinating	Adds information	She is intelligent and hardworking.
but	Coordinating	Shows contrast	It was expensive, but worth it.
or	Coordinating	Shows alternatives	You can call me or send an email.
so	Coordinating	Shows result	I was tired, so I went to bed early.
because	Subordinating	Gives reason	I was late because the traffic was terrible.
although	Subordinating	Unexpected contrast	Although it rained, we enjoyed the event.
even though	Subordinating	Strong contrast	Even though she was tired, she stayed late.
however	Conjunctive adverb	Contrast (formal)	The results were good. However, there is room for improvement.
unless	Subordinating	Negative condition	I won't attend unless it is absolutely necessary.
as soon as	Subordinating	Immediately when	I will call you as soon as I land.

CHAPTER 30

Practice Exercises — All Parts

Exercise 1 — SOME / ANY / NO / EVERY

1. There is _____ in the office — it is completely empty. (nobody / anybody)
2. Has _____ called while I was out? (someone / anyone)
3. I have looked _____ for my keys and I cannot find them. (everywhere / anywhere)
4. _____ has been done — we are still at the very beginning. (Nothing / Anything)
5. I would like to go _____ warm this winter. (somewhere / anywhere)
6. She didn't tell _____ about the promotion. (nobody / anybody)

Answers:

1. nobody · 2. anyone · 3. everywhere · 4. Nothing · 5. somewhere · 6. anybody

Exercise 2 — EITHER / NEITHER / BOTH

1. _____ of my colleagues speak Arabic. (Both / Either / Neither) — only one speaks it.
2. We can meet on _____ Wednesday or Thursday — whichever suits you. (both / either)
3. _____ the CEO nor the CFO was available. (Either / Neither)
4. I have visited _____ Paris and London in the same trip. (both / either)

Answers:

1. Neither · 2. either · 3. Neither · 4. both

Exercise 3 — Choose the Correct Sentence Structure

1. (I used to live / I was used to live) in a small town before I moved to the city.
2. I (should have called / should have been calling) you earlier — I apologise.
3. If I (knew / had known) about the event, I (would attend / would have attended).
4. She (keeps forgetting / keeps to forget) to submit her timesheets.
5. I (am looking forward to meet / am looking forward to meeting) you next week.
6. By the time you read this, I (will leave / will have left) for the airport.

Answers:

1. I used to live
2. should have called
3. had known / would have attended
4. keeps forgetting
5. looking forward to meeting

6. will have left**Exercise 4 — Add the Correct Question Tag**

1. You have submitted the report, _____?
2. She doesn't work on Fridays, _____?
3. They were at the conference, _____?
4. Let's take a short break, _____?
5. He can speak Mandarin, _____?
6. Nobody called while I was away, _____?

Answers:

1. haven't you? · 2. does she? · 3. weren't they? · 4. shall we? · 5. can't he? · 6. did they?

Exercise 5 — Translate into a WH-Question

1. She lives [in Dubai]. → _____
2. The meeting starts [at 3 o'clock]. → _____
3. He was late [because his flight was delayed]. → _____
4. [My colleague Ahmed] recommended you. → _____
5. I prefer [the blue one]. → _____
6. [Her brother] called her. → _____

Answers:

1. Where does she live?
2. When does the meeting start?
3. Why was he late?
4. Who recommended you?
5. Which one do you prefer?
6. Who called her?

QUICK REFERENCE SUMMARY

The Four Word Families

- SOME-: positive sentences
- ANY-: questions & negatives
- NO-: affirmative verb only
- EVERY-: all of a group

The Three Pronoun Rules

- Subject pronouns BEFORE the verb
- Object pronouns AFTER the verb or preposition
- Reflexive = subject & object same person

The Perfect Modal Rule

- Modal + have + past participle = judgement about the PAST
- should have = regret
- could have = missed opportunity
- would have = hypothetical past

The Question Tag Rule

- Positive statement + NEGATIVE tag
- Negative statement + POSITIVE tag
- Always match the auxiliary of the main verb